

Exchange when the ending suits you

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

Trading queens or rooks can reduce danger and make an advantage easier to convert. It can also remove the pieces that attack an enemy weakness. Evaluate the resulting ending before offering an exchange.

WORKED EXAMPLE

With an extra pawn and an active king, a queen trade may simplify winning chances. If your extra pawn is a rook pawn with the wrong bishop, simplifying into that ending may throw the advantage away.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you inspect before accepting a simplifying trade?

ANSWER AND REASONING

King activity, pawn structure, passed pawns, remaining piece quality, and known drawing resources. Count material after the trade, but do not stop there.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Simplify into a favorable position, not merely a smaller one.